



- A Brexit referendum was called by the then Conservative Prime Minister David Cameron and was held in the UK on 23 June 2016. 72% of the British electorate took part in the referendum and voted to leave the EU by 52% to 48%. After very problematic and contentious negotiations conducted by Prime Minister Theresa May and subsequently Boris Johnson, the UK left the EU on 31 January 2020.
- Keir Starmer won the 2024 general election with a large majority, putting the Labour Party in power for the first time in fourteen years. The *Daily Mirror* celebrated the win with the front page headline, 'Keir We Go. Starmer and Labour in thumping landslide victory'. Whilst not advocating a reversal of the Brexit decision, since his election win Keir Starmer has worked to establish closer ties with the EU in areas that would be beneficial to the UK.

Starting points – Media language

Front page - How the combination of elements of media language influence meaning

Newspapers share a repertoire of elements such as layout and design, use of language and mode of address, which are recognisable to audiences. These reflect the style of the newspaper and its readers and may differ slightly, for example between popular and quality newspapers.

Consider the different ways in which the **paradigmatic choices** of media language including visual codes, written language and mode of address communicate meanings on the set front page of the *Daily Mirror*:

- The page is divided between the central political story, two stories featuring popular celebrities and a **plug** offering free tickets for the racing, with the political story taking prominence. The choice of stories reflects the style of the newspaper, its political allegiance and the interests of the readers.
- The layout and design is conventional of this style of newspaper which is generally image- rather than text-led. The **masthead** is bold and recognisable as a red-top, tabloid newspaper. The typography chosen is strong and the name of the newspaper conveys messages about how the paper may 'hold a mirror' up to what is taking place in society.
- The **slogan** within the masthead '*The Heart of Britain*' suggests the central role the newspaper has in society and that it is compassionate and cares about what is happening to the people of the UK.
- The **headline** is brief and dramatic, typical of the paper's style and is positive about the success of Keir Starmer's deal. The use of his first name suggests the newspaper's affiliation with the Prime Minister (PM) and his policies. The **strapline** is presented in red suggesting the political importance of the 'pact'. In the **subheading**, '*PM says British shoppers, tourists and businesses will feel the benefit*', the newspaper has selected an aspect of the story that will resonate with its audience, focusing on what the deal will mean for the British public.
- The chosen image of Keir Starmer is a positive one, mediating the story for the reader. The **visual code** of the smile and the thumbs up communicates a positive message and reinforces the newspaper's support for the PM and his government which is to be expected from a left-wing newspaper. This is further reflected in the **caption**.
- The language used in the copy reflects the values and attitudes of the newspaper and their political allegiance citing, '*practical benefits for ordinary people*'. The newspaper includes direct quotations from the PM highlighting his positivity about the deal and